30. Ibid.

31. Falk (2006): 58.

32. See Line II of the Nittur version of Minor Rock Edict II, for instance. Sircar (1979):128. This paragraph is based on that version and what it says.

33. Raychaudhuri (1953): 255.

34. Thapar (1957). B.K. Thapar's excavations revealed a cultural sequence of four periods, stretching from chalcolithic times till the medieval. Period II, the megalithic culture, as he designated it, was assigned to the last three quarters of the first millennium BCE. For this, also see Ghosh (1989): 282. Thus, it was likely to have existed in the time of Ashoka. For an earlier assessment of Maski, Gordon and Gordon (1943).

35. Thapar (1957): 103.

36. Ibid.: 21, 24.

37. Hultzsch (1925): xxvi refers to the inscriptional references to Maski. The battlefield of Musangi is referred to in the Tirumalai rock inscription of Rajendra Chola I. See Hultzsch (1907–8): 233.

38. Thapar (1957): 119.

39. This is what K. Rajan's work has revealed. His unpublished work has been extensively cited in Chakrabarti (2006): 312–13.

40. Rajan and Yatheeskumar (2010–12): 290.

41. Wheeler (1947–8): 186.

42. While Mortimer Wheeler believed that the Polished Stone Axe culture's last phase was coterminous with the time of Ashoka, much earlier dates have been suggested for it subsequently, as also for the megaliths. See Ghosh (1989): 84.

43. Falk (2006): 65.

44. Wheeler (1947–8): 186–7.

45. Hultzsch (1925): xxvii.

46. Ibid.

47. Although *Indian Archaeology—A Review* (1976–7: 60) says the inscription was in the Prakrit language and Brahmi characters of about the second century BCE, the accompanying plate (LVIII C)